



From: Robert L. Glover, Lieutenant Colonel of Marines (Retired) / Principal Investigator,
Houston City College VICEROY Scholars Program
To: Office of the Under Secretary of Defense for Research and Engineering (OUSD(R&E))

Subj: Cesar Garrido – Houston City College – Letter of Recommendation

To the DoD Cyber Service Academy (CSA) Selection Committee:

It is my honor to recommend Mr. Cesar Garrido for the Department of Defense Cyber Service Academy (CSA) Scholarship. Mr. Garrido joined my VICEROY Scholars Program at Houston City College approximately two months ago. While my direct observation window has been relatively short, my professional assessment of his suitability for the CSA program is both deliberate and confident, grounded in a personal interview, program participation to date, and my own 22 years of service as a United States Marine Corps officer in leadership and evaluative billets.

Mr. Garrido is a United States Marine Corps veteran, having served as an 0311 Infantryman with multiple deployments in support of combat operations in Iraq and Afghanistan. That background matters. Combat arms Marines who have operated repeatedly in contested environments understand discipline, accountability, and mission execution at a level that cannot be taught in a classroom. Those attributes translate directly to success in Department of Defense cybersecurity roles, where persistence, clarity of thought under pressure, and adherence to mission objectives are non-negotiable.

The CSA evaluation criteria emphasize demonstrated potential, particularly where candidates show clear motivation for DoD service. During my personal interview with Mr. Garrido, he articulated a focused and credible intent to pursue a career in Department of Defense cybersecurity, viewing this transition not as a departure from service, but as a continuation of it. His motivation is intrinsic, mission-oriented, and aligned with national security priorities—precisely the mindset the CSA program is designed to cultivate.

Although early in his academic engagement with VICEROY, Mr. Garrido has already demonstrated the intellectual discipline and adaptability required in rigorous STEM environments. The CSA rubric values problem-solving ability and technical aptitude, and Mr. Garrido's approach to learning reflects a methodical, task-oriented mindset forged through operational military experience. He asks the right questions, seeks clarity before execution, and demonstrates a willingness to master complex material rather than merely complete assignments.

Leadership and participation are also core components of the CSA selection criteria. While Mr. Garrido does not seek attention, he carries himself with the quiet confidence of a seasoned Marine. He engages professionally with peers, contributes constructively in group settings, and brings a maturity shaped by real-world leadership under adverse conditions. These qualities significantly enhance team performance in both academic and operational environments.

Based on my experience evaluating Marines and civilian professionals across more than two decades of service, I do not make comparative rankings lightly. Among the 17 VICEROY



Scholars currently under my purview, I rank Mr. Garrido in my top five in terms of overall potential for success within the DoD CSA framework and subsequent service in the federal cybersecurity workforce. This assessment reflects not only his background and motivation, but his demonstrated capacity to transition effectively from kinetic operations to the cyber domain—a critical and growing need for the Department of Defense.

In summary, Cesar Garrido meets and, in several respects, exceeds the DoD CSA evaluation criteria, particularly in demonstrated potential, leadership, mission focus, and readiness for service. I recommend him enthusiastically and without reservation for the CSA Scholarship and am confident he will prove to be a disciplined, capable, and mission-driven asset to the Department of Defense.

Respectfully,

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